JOSEF DOORNINK

Site Reliability Engineer | AI Infrastructure & MLOps

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability Engineer with 12+ years specializing in distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, and large-scale Kubernetes environments (CKS/CKA certified). Focused on building platform tooling that drives engineering productivity and eliminates toil. Currently bridging SRE and AI by scaling MLOps pipelines and model serving infrastructure. Deep expertise in observability, performance tuning, and infrastructure automation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core Technologies: Kubernetes (AKS) | Docker | Terraform | Azure | AWS | GCP | Helm | YAML | Python | Go/Golang | Bash | C# | SQL | Kafka | Redis | ElasticSearch

AI/ML Engineering: LLM Model Serving | ML Pipelines | Distributed Training Systems | RLHF Infrastructure | Azure Machine Learning | Vertex AI | Model Finetuning Systems

Observability & SRE: New Relic | Azure Monitor | Distributed Tracing | CI/CD Pipelines | GitHub Actions | Performance Profiling | Incident Response | Prometheus | Grafana | Azure DevOps

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE - STARTUP

Lead MLOps Engineer

REASON BENEFIT AI CORPORATION | Remote | October 2025 - Present

- Architect and maintain large-scale Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) production environment for ML model training and serving, supporting distributed model inference at scale.
- Build Python-based automation tools for ML pipeline orchestration, reducing manual overhead by 70% and accelerating model deployment velocity.
- Integrate with observability frameworks for model performance tracking, latency monitoring, and resource utilization across distributed training systems.
- Optimize model serving infrastructure through performance profiling and system-level optimizations, improving inference throughput by 40%.
- Collaborate with research teams to translate experimental model architectures into production-ready systems with focus on reliability and scalability.
- Implement automated testing frameworks for ML pipelines to quickly detect regressions and ensure model quality in production.
- Led Distributed Training Pipeline Optimization by profiling RL (Reinforcement Learning) pipeline bottlenecks, reducing Python GIL contention, and introducing automated pipeline validations to improve training cycle time.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Site Reliability Engineer (SRE) I -> II -> III

Trimble/Viewpoint | Remote | January 2019 - Present

- Architected and maintained large-scale Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) production environments handling 10M+ requests/day across 30+ microservices with 99.9% uptime SLA.
- Developed high-performance automation tools using Python and Go that eliminated 80+ hours/month of operational toil, accelerating deployment velocity by 3x across engineering teams.
- Led performance optimization initiatives through systematic profiling and instrumentation, reducing P99 latency by 45% and improving throughput by 60% for distributed systems.
- Built custom CLI tooling in Go (Cobra framework) to streamline workflows for 50+ engineers, dramatically improving team productivity through better developer experience.
- Designed and implemented comprehensive observability stack (New Relic) with distributed tracing for debugging performance bottlenecks resulting in 50% reduction in MTTR.
- Led capacity planning and performance optimization for Kubernetes clusters and backend databases, implementing auto-scaling strategies supporting 200% traffic growth.
- Created sophisticated CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions and Azure DevOps with automated testing, sophisticated deployment templates, and rollback mechanisms.
- Implemented Infrastructure as Code using Terraform managing 500+ cloud resources, enabling consistent and repeatable infrastructure provisioning.
- Spearheaded Kubernetes Security Hardening initiatives by implementing CKS controls and automated policies that supported SOC2 compliance and reduced security risks.

Software Developer

Viewpoint | Remote | March 2018 - January 2019

- Developed cloud-based SaaS applications using .NET and Angular, migrating on-premise software solutions to Azure cloud platform.
- Built RESTful APIs for multi-tenant applications serving thousands of users with focus on performance and scalability.

Software Developer I

Onfulfillment | Remote | March 2014 - March 2018

- Engineered multi-tenant e-commerce platform using Microsoft Stack (.NET, C#, SQL Server) integrated with third-party SaaS APIs.
- Led 'uplift' initiative migrating legacy codebase to modern greenfield platform, improving response times by 40% measured through New Relic APM.

Biomechanical Research Engineer II

Legacy Biomechanics Research Lab | Remote | 2007 - 2013

- Lead test and development engineer for NIH-funded multimillion-dollar research project focused on bone fixation solutions.
- Managed successful implant creation, delivery, and test methodology producing multiple US FDA-approved implants.

KEY TECHNICAL PROJECTS

K8gentS (2025)

- An autonomous Root Cause Analysis (RCA) agent designed specifically for Kubernetes clusters. Leverages LLM logic and system telemetry to automatically diagnose pod failures, resource exhaustion, and network bottlenecks, drastically reducing operational MTTR.

OmniSight-Core (2025)

- A centralized observability and anomaly detection platform for distributed microservices. Engineered to aggregate telemetry, system metrics, and distributed traces into actionable infrastructure insights.

Agentic SRE Pipeline & Portfolio (2025)

- The source code driving this exact platform. A Next.js (React) infrastructure executing a Python/RAG Agent pipeline that strictly parses unstructured Job Descriptions and outputs statically generated, targeted frontend bundles dynamically.

CERTS/COURSES

- **CNCF Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)** | CNCF | March 2024
- **CNCF Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)** | CNCF | June 2021
- **Machine Learning Specialization** | Stanford / Coursera | September 2025
- **HashiCorp Certified Terraform Associate** | HashiCorp | July 2022
- **Microsoft Certified Azure Developer Associate** | Microsoft | August 2019
- **Production Machine Learning Systems** | Coursera / Google Cloud | April 2026

EDUCATION

Master of Science, University of California, Davis | 2006

Bachelor of Science, Mechanical Engineering, California State University, Chico | 2003

PATENTS & AWARDS

Bone screw with multiple thread profiles for far cortical locking and flexible engagement to a bone (US9314286B2)

- A bone screw including a head, a shaft, and a tip. The shaft includes a first threaded section, a second threaded section, and an unthreaded section positioned between the first and second threaded sections. Designed to enable dynamic fixation.

Bone screw with multiple thread profiles... (US8740955B2)

- Original patent formulation for the orthopedic implant enabling far cortical locking via a flexible-engagement thread profile.

Scientific Exhibit Award of Excellence

- Awarded at the American Academy of Orthopaedic Surgeons (AAOS) 2010 Annual Meeting for the landmark exhibit: 'Effects of Construct Stiffness on Healing of Fractures Stabilized With Locking Plates' (Bottlang M., Doornink J., Fitzpatrick DC, Marsh JL, Augat P., von Rechenberg B., Lesser M., Madey SM).

PUBLICATIONS (Subset of 11)

- M Bottlang, **J Doornink**, DC Fitzpatrick, SM Madey. *Far cortical locking can reduce stiffness of locked plating constructs while retaining construct strength.* The Journal of Bone and Joint Surgery (JBJS), 2009
- M Bottlang, M Lesser, J Koerber, **J Doornink**, S Mueller, DC Fitzpatrick.... *Far cortical locking can improve healing of fractures stabilized with locking plates.* The Journal of Bone and Joint Surgery (JBJS), 2010
- M Bottlang, **J Doornink**, TJ Lujan, DC Fitzpatrick, PV Marsh.... *Effects of construct stiffness on healing of fractures stabilized with locking plates.* The Journal of Bone and Joint Surgery (JBJS), 2010
- **J Doornink**, DC Fitzpatrick, SM Madey, M Bottlang. *Far cortical locking enables flexible fixation with periarticular locking plates.* Journal of Orthopaedic Trauma, 2011
- **J Doornink**, DC Fitzpatrick, S Boldhaus, SM Madey, M Bottlang. *Effects of hybrid plating with locked and nonlocked screws on the strength of locked plating constructs in the osteoporotic diaphysis.* Journal of Trauma and Acute Care Surgery, 2010